

HOUSE BILL 1518

By Baum

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49,
Chapter 4, relative to financial aid.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 49-4-907, is amended by designating the existing language as subsection (a) and adding the following as a new subsection:

(b) If a student is not eligible for a Tennessee HOPE scholarship as an entering freshman pursuant to subsection (a) based on the student's high school grade point average or composite ACT score, then the student is eligible for the Tennessee HOPE scholarship as a transfer student if the student:

(1) Meets the requirements of §§ 49-4-904 and 49-4-905;

(2) Is admitted to and enrolled in an eligible postsecondary institution no later than six (6) months after obtaining the student's first associate degree or certificate from an eligible postsecondary institution, as defined in § 49-4-708, as a Tennessee Promise scholarship student, as defined in § 49-4-708;

(3) Received the Tennessee Promise scholarship, or maintained the student's eligibility for the scholarship, each semester that the student was enrolled in the eligible postsecondary institution, as defined in § 49-4-708, at which the student earned their first certificate or associate degree; and

(4) Achieved a final overall grade point average at the eligible postsecondary institution, as defined in § 49-4-708, of at least 3.0.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it, and applies to the 2026-2027 academic year and each academic year thereafter.